# 11

IN MY FIRST YEAR AND A HALF at Warner Brothers, I made thirteen pictures. Usually, I was in and out of a movie in three or four weeks. You worked from eight in the morning until seven at night.

Between pictures, I went horseback riding in Griffith Park, learned how to body surf in the Pacific Ocean, and tried to keep up with the demands of the studio publicity machine. Press agents were constantly trying to pair me with my leading ladies and new starlets, a fringe benefit to which I usually didn't object, and wherever I went, they assigned a photographer to follow and collect material for the fan magazines. The experience left me with a lifelong distaste for formalized picture-taking sessions.

After we had filmed *Love Is on the Air*, one of our cameramen told me: "Kid, I don't think you should wear makeup.

"There are some people who have complexions that for some reason or other just can't take makeup well and I think you're one of 'em. What I mean is that you can literally see the makeup on your skin."

Before long, he said it was likely I'd be asked to act out a few lines in a screen test for another new contract player and when that happened, he suggested, "Why don't you try doing the scene without wearing makeup? Some people look better without it than with it." We did the test and he was right. I never wore makeup again.

I had always hated my glasses and after moving to Hollywood I enthusiastically became a guinea pig for some of the first pairs of contact lenses available in this country. They were big, rigid, and fit over the whites of your eyes like